

## Interview Questionnaire

### Rapport Building Questions: How cybersecurity professionals understand “Trust”

- (1) Can you explain your understanding of “Trust” in the context of cybersecurity?
- (2) How does your organization currently approach trust and security?
- (3) Can you share any examples of trust-related incidents or challenges commonly faced by organizations within your industry sector?

### Part 1: Definition and Understanding of Zero Trust

- (4) What are your thoughts on Zero Trust? What was your initial reaction or impression upon learning about it?
  - (a) In your experience, how has the understanding (thoughts and opinions) of Zero Trust evolved within the cybersecurity community over the years?
  - (b) Have you observed any shifts in perception or adoption?
- (5) How would you define Zero Trust in your own words, and what does it mean to you as a cybersecurity professional?
- (6) How would you differentiate Zero Trust from traditional cybersecurity practices [that rely on manageable trust assumptions]?
- (7) What specific areas of security does it address/enhance/ tackle?
- (8) From your perspective, what are some of the primary benefits or advantages that Zero Trust offers to organizations in terms of enhancing their security posture?
- (9) Do you identify any potential shortcomings or limitations associated with Zero Trust? If so, what are they, and how do you think they can be addressed?
- (10) What resources do you typically refer to learn more about Zero Trust?
  - (a) Which resources you find most helpful for obtaining reliable information?
  - (b) Have you encountered any challenges or frustrations in finding appropriate and accurate resources about Zero Trust? If so, could you share some examples of those difficulties?
- (11) Is having a Zero Trust mindset crucial in this age of cybersecurity? Why?

### Part 2: Strategies, Components, Resources, Best Practices, Recommendations, and Challenges for Zero Trust

- (12) For what types of enterprises would Zero Trust migration be particularly important or crucial?
  - (a) Conversely, which enterprises might find the migration process easier or more difficult?
- (13) In order to move to Zero Trust, what essential capabilities, skills, and resources [tools and frameworks] does an organization need to possess or develop?
- (14) Are there any transition costs anticipated or associated with this endeavor of moving to Zero Trust?
  - (a) Which aspects, such as budget, personnel, tools, knowledge, or skills, are typically affected?
  - (b) When implementing or migrating to Zero Trust, what are the key expectations from different stakeholders, including employees, users, senior decision-makers, and other

relevant parties? How do these expectations impact the implementation process?

- (15) Did your enterprise migrate to Zero Trust?
  - (a) Could you share the reasons that motivated/prompted this decision?
- (16) What are the challenges in the process of migrating to Zero Trust? and how were they/ can they be addressed or mitigated?
- (17) How can the progress of Zero Trust migration measured?
- (18) Based on your experience, what recommendations or suggestions would you offer to other organizations that are considering or planning to move to Zero Trust?
  - (a) What key insights or lessons learned would you share with them?

### Alternate Version of Part 2 (Use for Academia Participants):

- How are you trying to translate/engage with Zero Trust? Please describe the strategies, steps, and components involved.
- What resources, frameworks, or tools are crucial for successfully understanding and translating Zero Trust?
- Are there any notable challenges or obstacles when adopting Zero Trust in your research context? Please provide examples if possible.
- Can you share any best practices or recommendations for those adopting Zero Trust?

### Part 3: Forward-looking perspectives

- (19) In your opinion, how do you foresee the adoption of Zero Trust evolving in the cybersecurity landscape over the next five to ten years? Do you anticipate any emerging trends or changes in the way Zero Trust is applied in the coming years?
- (20) Are there any specific areas or aspects of Zero Trust that you believe require further research or development?

### Additional Comments

- Is there anything else you would like to add regarding Zero Trust or, any topics that you believe were not covered?
- How do you find the term “Zero Trust?”